

VisaGuard

Stop paying for applications that were never going to pass.

A complete guide to every page, the staff workspace and the student portal, and what changes for your consultancy when you use it.

Case management and refusal-risk screening for study-visa consultancies

UK · Germany · Italy · France

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Disclaimer. VisaGuard is a decision-support tool, not legal or immigration advice. Its results depend on the rules your staff verify and on the documents provided. It never guarantees admission or a visa. AI reads and explains; a person always decides.

1. The problem VisaGuard solves

Most losses in a study-visa consultancy do not come from bad luck. They come from a check that was skipped while the office was busy. A few examples that every consultancy will recognise:

- A non-refundable university deposit is paid, and only then someone notices the student's CGPA is below the programme minimum.
- A UK visa is filed with a bank statement whose balance dipped below the required amount for a few days inside the 28-day window. The embassy refuses it.
- A German application waits on an APS certificate that cannot arrive before the deadline, because the HEC → MOFA attestation was started too late.
- The name on the matric certificate is spelt differently from the passport, and nobody spotted it until the visa interview.
- A rule changed (a new maintenance amount, a new deadline) and the office kept using last year's number.

Each of these costs the student money and often a whole intake, and it costs the consultancy its reputation. VisaGuard puts a locked gate in front of every step that cannot be undone, and checks everything before the gate opens.

2. How it works in one minute

Think of airport security. You cannot board until every check is clear, and nobody, not even the airport manager, can wave you through without a record. VisaGuard works the same way.

Every case moves through 11 stages, always in order

Stage	What must be true before a case can enter it
1. Lead	A student has been added.
2. Profile Complete	Profile at least 90% complete and the student's consent recorded.
3. Docs Verified	Every document needed before payment is uploaded and verified by a staff member; no unresolved critical flags.
4. Eligibility Passed	A fresh assessment is GREEN, or a manager override plus the student's signed acknowledgment.
5. Manager Approved	Same as above, and approved by a Manager or Owner.
6. Payment Authorized (locked)	Only through Pre-flight: an officer and a different manager both confirm the amount.
7. Submitted (locked)	Only through Pre-flight.
8. Offer/Admission	Offer details recorded.
9. Visa Filed (locked)	Only through Pre-flight.
10. Decision	Outcome recorded (approved, refused or withdrawn).
11. Pre-departure	Travel and arrival preparation.

The traffic light

GREEN	Every check passed on verified, up-to-date rules. The case can go to Pre-flight. GREEN is not a guarantee of a visa; it means no known problem.
AMBER	Something needs attention: a warning, missing data, or a rule that a manager has not verified. AMBER never becomes GREEN by itself.
RED	A blocking problem, for example CGPA below the minimum, funds failing the 28-day test, or a required step that cannot finish in time. Payment and submission are locked.

Three promises the system keeps

- **Nothing irreversible happens until the gates pass.** Paying a non-refundable fee, submitting an application and filing a visa are locked behind Pre-flight. There is no back door: the same check runs whether the request comes from a screen, an integration or a direct database call.
- **Two people confirm every non-refundable payment.** The officer requests it; a different manager approves it, seeing a red banner with the exact amount in PKR.
- **Everything is recorded.** Every change, approval, override and AI output goes into an audit log that cannot be edited or deleted.

3. Who uses it: the five roles

Each person signs in with their own account and sees only what their role allows. The server enforces these limits, not just the screen.

Role	Typical person	What they can do
Owner / Admin	Consultancy owner	Everything: owner dashboard with money metrics, users and roles, delete student data, approvals, rules.
Manager	Branch or processing manager	Second confirmation on payments, grant overrides with a written reason, verify rules, approve cases.
Processing Officer	Case officer	Run cases day to day: documents, analyses, start Pre-flight, record refundable payments, tasks.
Counsellor	Front-desk counsellor	Add students, fill profiles, run matching, create cases. Cannot approve or pay.
Student	The applicant	Own portal only: plain-language status, checklist, uploads, signing risk acknowledgments. Never sees internal scores.

Two-person rule. The manager who confirms a payment must be a different person from the officer who requested it. A manager cannot approve their own request. Keep at least two people with the Manager or Owner role.

4. The staff workspace, page by page

These pages are in the left-hand menu (on a phone, behind the menu button). The top bar shows your role, notifications, a light/dark mode switch and sign-out.

Sign-in page

Address: /login

Staff sign in with their email and password. In the demo version there are also one-click buttons to try each role.

Dashboard

Menu: Dashboard

The first screen after signing in. Owners see the whole consultancy; other staff see their own work.

- **Open cases, cases blocked by gates, deadlines in the next 30 days.**
- **Estimated money protected:** non-refundable amounts that staff tried to pay but the gates stopped.
- **Money exposed:** non-refundable money already paid on cases that are still RED.
- Pipeline by stage, GREEN/AMBER/RED counts, rules needing verification, what the gates caught most often, each officer's block rate (a training signal, not blame), refusal reasons, and conversion by country.

Who can use it: everyone on staff; money metrics for Owner

Cases

Menu: Cases

A list of every case with its light, stage, intake date, officer and open flags. Filter by country, status, stage or 'assigned to me'. One case is one student applying to one programme.

Who can use it: all staff

Students

Menu: Students

Add a new student with just a name and phone number, then open the profile. The list shows each student's profile completeness, their cases and whether consent is recorded. Search by name, email, phone or CNIC.

Who can use it: all staff

Student profile

Students → open a student

The full profile editor with a live completeness meter: personal details exactly as on the passport, education with grading scale, study gaps, English tests, work experience, sponsors and budget, study plans, visa refusals and travel history, ties to Pakistan, and staff-only internal notes.

- Create a **secure intake link** (valid 7 days) so the student fills in the profile themselves, or create a **portal account**.
- Upload documents shared across all of the student's cases.
- Export everything held about the student as a file, or (Owner only) delete the student's data permanently.

Who can use it: all staff can view; Owner, Manager, Officer, Counsellor can edit

Country & university matching

Student profile → Country & university matching

Ranks programmes across the four countries for this student. Each option shows a fit score, an acceptance-chance band, a visa-risk band, whether the intake is open, the estimated first-year cost in PKR, why it was suggested and what is missing. If nothing fits well, it says so honestly and suggests alternatives (for example a foundation year or improving IELTS). One click creates a case.

New case

Student profile → New case

Pick a programme from the database to fill in its requirements automatically (minimum CGPA, English scores, tuition, intake dates), or enter them by hand. The requirements are saved on the case at that moment, so later edits to the database do not change a case silently.

Approvals

Menu: Approvals

The manager's queue: Pre-flights waiting for the second confirmation (with the amount and whether it is refundable), risk acknowledgments waiting for the student's signature, and recent decisions.

Who can use it: Manager, Owner

Tasks & deadlines

Menu: Tasks & deadlines

Tasks are created automatically from each case's country, stage and checklist (for example 'Start HEC attestation' or 'Upload a fresh bank statement'). Overdue tasks show in red. The Notifications panel lists alerts such as a blocked payment or a deadline in 7 days. You can also add your own tasks.

Who can use it: all staff

Payments ledger

Menu: Payments ledger

Every payment across the consultancy: amount, PKR equivalent, refundable or not, status and who authorised it. Non-refundable payments on risky cases are highlighted. Non-refundable entries can only appear here through an executed Pre-flight.

Who can use it: all staff

Rules engine

Menu: Rules engine

Every number the system uses lives here, never hidden in the software: UK monthly maintenance, German blocked-account amount, Italy and France funds, the 28-day holding period, deadlines, attestation durations, exchange rates. Each rule has its value, the official source link, who verified it and when.

- Status is **Verified**, **Unverified** or **Conflicting**; a rule not checked for 60 days becomes **STALE** automatically.
- A case can never be GREEN while a rule it depends on is Unverified, Conflicting or Stale.
- Managers verify a rule with one click after checking the official source; officers' edits are saved as Unverified.
- The **Rule changelog** shows every change: who, when, before and after, and why.

Who can use it: all staff can view; Officer and above can edit; Manager and Owner verify

Universities & programmes

Menu: Universities

Your programme database by country: minimum grades, English requirements, tuition, duration, intakes and deadlines, and compliance notes. Matching and new cases read from here. Demo entries are fictional and marked 'Sample data'.

Who can use it: all staff view; Manager and Owner edit

Audit log

Menu: Audit log

Every action in the system, newest first: who did it, their role, what changed (before and after) and, for AI outputs, which model and prompt version produced them. A banner confirms the log has not been tampered with; each entry is chained to the previous one, so editing or removing an entry is detected.

Who can use it: Owner, Manager, Officer

Settings

Menu: Settings

Shows which database, AI and sign-in services are connected, lists users and roles (Owner can add or deactivate staff), and in the demo version offers a one-click reset of the demo data.

Who can use it: all staff; user management Owner only

5. Inside a case: the eight tabs

Opening a case shows a header with the student, university, programme, intake, the risk score out of 100 and the traffic light, plus a strip showing all 11 stages with the current one highlighted. Below it are eight tabs.

Tab 1 — Risk report

The default tab

Everything that matters on one screen, written for a busy manager:

- A coloured banner with the light and the main reason, and whether payment and submission are blocked (with the list of blockers).
- **Top risks**, each with what was found, how to fix it, and what it is based on (the rule, document or analysis).
- **What to fix** and **What to ask the student** as numbered lists.
- A checklist of all requirements and countdowns to every deadline.
- **Explain with AI** adds a plain-language explanation that cites the findings. It explains the result; it cannot change it.
- **Export PDF** produces a one-page Refusal Risk Report to discuss with the student or keep on file.

Tab 2 — Documents

Case → Documents

The country checklist (each item shows which step it is needed before), an upload box and every uploaded document.

- The AI reads each document into fields (name, date of birth, passport number, CGPA, balances).
- Automatic checks: all pages present, readable, not expired, correct document type.
- Cross-document checks: name spelling differences, date-of-birth or passport-number mismatches, grades that differ from the profile, a bank account in someone other than the student or a declared sponsor, a CAS that does not match the case.
- Each problem is flagged **NEEDS MANUAL VERIFICATION**, never 'fake'. A staff member resolves it with a written note and then marks the document verified.
- Text inside a document that tries to give the AI instructions is treated as data and flagged.
- **Attestation tracker** (Pakistan): HEC, MOFA, embassy, APS and so on, with expected days per step, an expected finish date and overdue warnings. A chain that cannot finish before the deadline turns the case RED.

Tab 3 — Eligibility & gates data

Case → Eligibility

The detailed assessment behind the light: a score for each category (Academic, Language, Financial, Documents, Timeline, Credibility, Country, Rules) and every finding grouped by category. 'Insufficient data' means the system refused to guess.

- **Country gates**: country-specific steps with status and dates, for example UK CAS and TB test, German APS and blocked account, Italian Universitaly pre-enrolment and DoV/CIMEA, French Campus France interview.
- CAS details for UK cases, checked against the uploaded CAS.
- Every rule this assessment depends on, with its status.
- Edit the case details (requirements, dates, tuition); the case is re-assessed immediately.

Tab 4 — Financial

Case → Financial

The bank-statement analyser.

- **Required amount** worked out line by line from the rules (tuition still to pay plus living costs for the country), converted to the statement's currency.
- **Daily balance chart** over the holding window, with the required line and the first day the balance fell below it.
- The exact failing day and shortfall, for example 'fails on day 19, short by PKR 531,012', and the earliest date the student could apply after rebuilding the balance.
- **Large deposits** compared with the account's normal activity; each needs a staff-verified source of funds.
- **Fix this**: genuine steps to take. VisaGuard never helps create, borrow or disguise funds.
- Analyse an uploaded statement, or type one in by hand if it cannot be read.

Tab 5 — Gates & pre-flight

Case → Gates & pre-flight

The control room for moving the case forward.

- Shows the next stage and whether its gate is open, with every reason if it is closed.
- **Pre-flight** for locked steps: the officer sees the light, rule status and all warnings, enters the amount, currency and whether it is refundable, and ticks two confirmations. A red 'Money at risk' banner appears for non-refundable money.
- A different manager then confirms. At that moment the system re-checks everything from current data; if anything changed, nothing is executed.
- **Manager override** for a RED case: needs a written reason of at least 30 characters, cannot bypass unverified rules, and stops applying as soon as the assessment changes. The student must also sign a risk acknowledgment.
- **Gate history**: every attempt, including blocked ones with the amount that was stopped.

Tab 6 — Payments

Case → Payments

This case's payments with totals: everything recorded, non-refundable, and money exposed while the case is risky. Record refundable payments here (non-refundable ones only come from Pre-flight), mark payments as paid, refunded or void, and attach receipts.

Tab 7 — Tasks & messages

Case → Tasks & messages

Open and completed tasks, countdowns, and **copy-ready messages** for WhatsApp and email (document requests, deadline reminders, status updates) filled in with the student's details. Nothing is sent automatically; you copy, check and send. Internal scores are never included.

Tab 8 — Audit

Case → Audit

The audit trail for this case only: every change, approval, upload and AI output with who, when and what changed.

Who can use it: Owner, Manager, Officer

6. The student side

Students never see risk scores, traffic lights or staff notes. They see plain language about what is happening and what they need to do.

Student portal

Address: /portal (student signs in)

For each application: the university, programme, country and start date, a plain-language status for the current stage (for example 'Your documents have been checked. We are now assessing your eligibility.') and a personal checklist.

- Each document shows 'checked by our team', 'received, being checked', 'please upload again' (with the reason) or 'please upload'.
- The student uploads missing documents directly; staff are notified to review them.
- A list of files the student has shared.
- A reminder that the consultancy will never ask them to change, borrow or create documents or bank balances.

Signing a risk acknowledgment

Portal → Read & sign

Only appears when a manager has decided to proceed with a risky case. The student reads the specific risks in plain language and the warning that fees may be lost, types their full name exactly as on the passport, draws a signature and ticks agreement. The time and device are recorded. If the case changes materially afterwards, a new signature is required.

Secure intake link

Address: /intake/... (sent by the consultancy)

A private link, valid for 7 days, that lets a student fill in their whole profile from their phone without creating an account. They give consent at the end. Staff-only fields are hidden. A new link can be generated at any time, which cancels the old one.

7. Benefits of using VisaGuard

Benefit	What it means in practice
No more paying for doomed applications	A non-refundable fee cannot be paid while the case is RED. The dashboard shows how much money the gates stopped.
Fewer visa refusals	The 28-day funds test, deadlines, attestation timing and document mismatches are caught before filing, not by the embassy.
Two-person control on money	Every non-refundable payment needs an officer and a different manager, with the amount shown in PKR.
Rules you can trust	Every amount and deadline has a source link, a verifier and a date. Old rules expire after 60 days, so nobody works from last year's numbers.
Faster, consistent case work	Automatic checklists, tasks and countdowns per country; copy-ready messages; one-page risk report.
Mistakes caught across documents	Spelling variants, date-of-birth and passport mismatches, grade differences and unknown account holders are flagged automatically.
Honest advice to students	Matching tells students plainly when there is no strong option and what to improve. That builds trust and referrals.
Protection in disputes	When a student or parent complains, you have the signed risk acknowledgment, the override reason and the full audit trail.
Visibility for the owner	Pipeline, blocked cases, deadlines, money protected and exposed, and each officer's error rate on one screen.
Less dependence on one experienced person	The knowledge lives in the rules and checklists, so new staff follow the same process.
Student data handled properly	Consent recorded, encrypted document storage, role-based access, data export and permanent deletion on request.

8. What it costs you to keep working without it

Without a system like this, the consultancy relies on memory, spreadsheets and WhatsApp threads. The risks below are the ones VisaGuard is designed to remove.

Risk without VisaGuard	Typical consequence
A fee is paid before eligibility is checked	Lost deposit (often PKR 0.5–1.5 million), an angry family, and a refund demand on the consultancy.
Funds dip inside the 28-day window	Visa refused; the refusal stays on the student's record for future applications.
Attestation started too late	Deadline missed and the intake lost; the student waits six months or a year.
Outdated rule used	Wrong amount shown to the student; application fails on a technicality.
Spelling or date mismatch across documents	Questions or refusal at the embassy; credibility damaged.
One person approves their own payment	No second check; mistakes and misuse go unnoticed.
No written record of advice	In a dispute it is the student's word against the consultancy's.
Owner cannot see the pipeline	Problems surface only when a student complains or a refusal arrives.
Process lives in a senior officer's head	Quality drops when that person is away or leaves.

The simple calculation. If the gates stop just one wrongly paid deposit a year, they have saved around PKR 1 million, plus the student's year and the consultancy's reputation. In the demo data alone, blocked attempts add up to about PKR 1.4 million.

9. What VisaGuard does not do

Being clear about the limits is part of using it well.

- **It does not guarantee admission or a visa.** GREEN means no known problem on verified rules. Embassies and universities make the decisions.
- **It is not legal or immigration advice.** It supports your staff's judgement.
- **The rules are only as good as your verification.** A manager must check each rule against the official source. Until then, cases stay AMBER by design.
- **AI can misread a document.** That is why every document must be verified by staff before the payment stage, and why flags say 'needs manual verification'.
- **It never helps create, alter or disguise documents or funds.** It only detects problems and suggests genuine fixes.
- **It sends nothing on its own.** Messages are drafted for staff to copy and send.

About the demo version

- Students, universities and documents in the demo are fictional. Sample files are stamped 'SAMPLE DEMO FILE — NOT A REAL DOCUMENT'.
- Rule values are seed data that must be verified against official sources before real use.
- Document reading in the demo uses a simulated reader. The live version uses Claude AI to read real documents.
- Anyone with the demo link can pick any role. Never enter real student data in demo mode.

10. Getting started

Step	What to do	Who
1	Create staff accounts with the right roles; keep at least two managers.	Owner
2	Check every rule on the Rules page against the official source and mark it verified.	Manager
3	Replace the sample universities with your real programmes, minimum grades, fees and deadlines.	Manager / Officer
4	Set attestation durations from your own recent cases, and update exchange rates regularly.	Manager
5	Move current students in: add each one, send the secure intake link, upload documents.	Counsellor / Officer
6	Run every new payment and submission through Pre-flight. Review the dashboard weekly.	Everyone

A five-minute demo

Open	What it shows
Dashboard (as Owner)	Money protected, blocked cases, deadlines.
Hamza Iqbal's case — RED	A £3,000 non-refundable deposit was blocked because CGPA 2.45 is below the 3.00 minimum.
Ayesha Noor → Financial	The balance dips below the requirement on day 19 of the 28-day window, with the exact shortfall.
Zainab Hussain — AMBER	A clean file held back only by an unverified France rule; a manager verifies it and the case turns GREEN.
Omar Farooq → Gates & pre-flight	The full two-person payment: officer requests, a different manager confirms, the stage moves on.
Student portal (as Hamza)	What the student sees: plain-language status and checklist, no scores.